

# PENAL LEGION SQUAD

**DESPERATE, DAMNED, DISPOSABLE**

ASTRA MILITARUM • PENAL LEGION • IMPERIUM

**M**  
**6"****T**  
**3****SV**  
**5+****W**  
**1****LD**  
**8+****OC**  
**2**

NO INVULNERABLE SAVE (FLAK ARMOUR). SQUAD OF 10 MODELS. —

## RANGED WEAPONS

| WEAPON                       | RANGE | A | BS | S | AP | D | KEYWORDS                    |
|------------------------------|-------|---|----|---|----|---|-----------------------------|
| Laspistol                    | 12"   | 1 | 4+ | 3 | 0  | 1 | Pistol                      |
| Autogun (Custodian Sergeant) | 24"   | 2 | 4+ | 3 | 0  | 1 | Rapid Fire 2                |
| Shotgun (3 models)           | 12"   | 2 | 4+ | 4 | 0  | 1 | Assault                     |
| Grenade launcher (1 model)   | 24"   | 1 | 4+ | 5 | 0  | 1 | Anti-Infantry 4+, Frag/Krak |

## MELEE WEAPONS

| WEAPON                          | RANGE | A | WS | S | AP | D | KEYWORDS                |
|---------------------------------|-------|---|----|---|----|---|-------------------------|
| Improvised CCW                  | Melee | 2 | 4+ | 3 | 0  | 1 | —                       |
| Shock maul (Custodian Sergeant) | Melee | 3 | 3+ | 5 | -1 | 1 | Stun (Anti-Infantry 4+) |

Half the squad were murderers before the press-gang arrived. The other half were just unlucky. The Custodian Sergeant carries a shock-maul that doubles as their detonator key.

## ABILITIES

### Faction

Voice of Command (the squad benefits from Officer Orders but cannot issue them).

### Explosive Collars

Each model in this unit wears a remotely-triggered explosive collar. This unit automatically passes Battle-shock tests and cannot Fall Back. If the **Custodian Sergeant** is destroyed by an enemy attack, roll one D6 at the end of the phase: on a 4+, the surviving Convicts go berserk and gain +1 Attack and the **[LETHAL HITS]** ability until the start of your next turn, then are removed from the battlefield.

### Desperadoes

At the start of each of your turns, roll one D6 to determine the squad's mood for the turn:

**1-2 — Berserk Charge:** Melee weapons gain **[LETHAL HITS]**.

**3-4 — Crack Shots:** Ranged weapons gain +1 BS (improves Hit characteristic by 1).

**5-6 — Bloodthirsty:** Melee weapons gain **[SUSTAINED HITS 1]**.

### Press-Ganged

This unit cannot be selected as an army Warlord and cannot be the target of friendly Order abilities except **Take Aim!** and **Fix Bayonets!** (or their Officer-issued equivalents). They will follow only orders they understand.

### Penal Squad Composition

1 Custodian Sergeant (autogun + shock maul) + 9 Convicts (8 with laspistol + improvised CCW, of which 3 swap their pistol for a shotgun, plus 1 with grenade launcher).

### Designer's Note

**Homebrew — 7th Ed source.** Penal Legion squads first appeared in 3rd Ed Codex: Imperial Guard (1999) and were maintained through 7th Ed Codex: Astra Militarum (2014) before being dropped in 8th Ed. The classic identity was three-fold: (1) randomised behaviour each turn via the Desperadoes "psychotic" roll; (2) Custodian Sergeant who keeps them in line; (3) explosive collars enforcing morale at the cost of being unable to retreat. This 10e conversion preserves all three: Desperadoes maps the old D6 mood table onto modern keywords (Lethal Hits / +1 BS / Sustained Hits), Explosive Collars maps to automatic Battle-shock pass + a "go berserk on death" trigger, and the Custodian Sergeant is the squad's targetable lynchpin. Press-Ganged restricts Officer synergies to keep the squad feeling like outsiders.

#### KEYWORDS

Infantry • Battleline • Penal Legion • Imperium • Astra Militarum • Faction: Astra Militarum